2. Regarding the second warning, April–June, the main planning and preparations had already been completed, but there were very few reports of preparations on the ground. Egypt and Syria had not yet closed all of the existing gaps (for example, depth, electronic warfare, and antiaircraft missiles). In addition, the Soviet Union sought to postpone the deadline, promising Sadat that if the forthcoming summit (in Washington in July 1973) ended with no results, the Russians would supply Egypt with the offensive weapons needed for attacks deep inside enemy territory.
3. The third date, September–October, appeared to be a direct continuation of the second, postponed, date. The stage of planning on both fronts was essentially the same as what had been reported to us regarding April–June, and armament had now been completed. An unprecedented number of reports of preparations on the ground were coming in as this date neared.

Some Mossad sources also held the opinion that Sadat would not go to war. These views were based on the assumption that just as Sadat had not fulfilled his promises to go to war in the past, the same would be true this time around. Such views were expressed as late as mid-September 1973. *But from Rosh Hashanah onwards, during the last ten days before the outbreak of the war, sources reported only the intention to go to war, with no reservations whatsoever.*

Time A: Late 1972 to early 1973

Among the explanations for this possible time were:

1. The academic year at the universities was set to begin on October 31, and this was a particularly sensitive time in terms of domestic pressures.
2. It would put pressure on the United States ahead of elections.
3. It would also put pressure on the upcoming UN General Assembly discussions.